

these symbols were imbibed from nature with a deep reverence, which only those initiated into the ways of the organization could comprehend.

It was during the middle ages that ciphers became increasingly popular. Governments used them to communicate with their ambassadors in other countries, and it was not only the Western nations which had begun to understand the importance of having an unbreakable code.

Eastern codes

The Ancient Chinese utilised the pictorial (ideographs, to be precise) form of their language to enclose the deeper meanings attached to the words. Most often, messages would be conveyed in ideographs to maintain secrecy. However, such use of cryptography is not apparent in any of China's earlier military conquests.

History claims that most ciphers in India were highly advanced, with the Government employing complicated codes to communicate with their spies distributed across the length and breadth of the country.

However, one of the first credible advances in this field was devised in Italy. An exhaustive organization was set up in Venice in 1452 to deal with cryptography. This ensured that all ciphers were solved and segregated for the Government's discretion.



First mention of cryptography in Iliad

All In Greek

The Greeks are believed to have been well acquainted with the use of ciphers, which were right before the eyes but seldom noticed. The Greek historian Herodotus revealed instances of secret messages hidden beneath the wax on wooden tablets and also of situations where discrete information was tattooed on a slave's head and covered by regrown hair. Those were perhaps the crudest forms of steg-